

Bris

לכבוד the ברית coming up of our new member of our family, a היליגא כהן. In פרשת שמות, baby משה is sent down the river Nile in a basket and פרעה's daughter finds him. She looks at him and she says, "This is a very cute kid, I want to keep him". She decides to allow him to live.

רש"י tells us, it's not in the pasuk but it's in רש"י, that she went from one nursing mother to another and baby משה'לע refused to drink. Why? רש"י says because the פה that is destined to speak with the שכינה should not be drinking milk from a goyish, טמא person.

The Vilna Gaon explains that this is the source of the הלכה by the רמ"א that the milk of an Egyptian nurse wet nurse is like is exactly like the milk of a Jew. It's כשר, however, if a person can possibly get a Jewish nursing woman to feed the baby, one should not take the Egyptian mother, should rather use the Jewish mother. Why? Because the milk of an עובד עבודה זרה has a very negative effect on a baby. So we could try as hard as we can not to do that.

R' Yaakov Kamenetsky asks a שטארקע קשיא, a סתירה מיניה וביה. There's a סתירה here. How is it possible to say that a child should not drink from a non-Jewish person's milk? The whole story is learned from משה רבינו, and in his case, he was not allowed to drink from a goyish woman because he was going to speak to the שכינה. How about all the rest of us?

What does R' Yaakov answer? That from this we learn a tremendous lesson in how we raise our children. Every kid has the potential to speak to the שכינה. That's how every parent should look at his child. "I want my child to fulfill his maximum potential, which is what? To go all the way up to the level of משה רבינו and speak to the שכינה." They should continue to raise him and treat him in exactly the same way as משה רבינו was treated, because he is their potential משה, each and every Jewish child is a potential משה.

